

1- Worship Allah Alone

Luqman calls his son “my son” rather than by name so as to emphasize the familial bond. He catches his attention encouraging him to listen carefully to what he is about to say. He then calls his son’s attention to what is the most important thing in the eyes of God.

The one who [associates others](#) with God, he says, does the biggest wrong or injustice to the Creator and Sustainer of the universe. That person also does a great wrong to himself because he offers himself up to the possibility of God’s anger and an eternal punishment.

2- Be Good to Parents

In the Quran Allah mentions the rights of [parents](#) in the same sentence as the most important aspect of Islam, worshiping God alone. This indicates that being [kind to parents](#), honoring and respecting them, is extremely important in the way of life that is Islam.

In the following part of Chapter Luqman, [31:14](#), God clarifies the difficulties mothers in particular go through raising their children and demands that the child gives thanks to his parents. God reminds us then that it is to Him that we will return so our first allegiance is to God alone, followed by devotion and kindness to our parents.

3- Remember Allah’s Might

Luqman then advises his son to remember the might and power that belongs to God. God’s knowledge is perfect, anything that happens or will happen in this world is already known by God. God’s might is absolute and should not be questioned, challenged or ignored by anyone.

4- Prayer

Luqman advises his son to pray regularly and in the right time frame. All parents should teach their children not only how to pray but why we pray and its importance. The Arabic word for prayer is *salah* and the word denotes connection.

[Prayer](#) is our way of connecting with and maintaining a [connection with God](#).

Prayer at fixed times serves as a reminder of why we are here and helps to direct thoughts and actions away from sin and onto the remembrance of God.

5- Enjoin the Good

Enjoining good and forbidding evil is a responsibility on every believer; rulers and subjects, men and women, each according to his or her ability.

6- Be Patient

Luqman advises his son to pray perfectly, enjoin good and forbid evil and then recommends patience when dealing with people for this purpose and in all matters. Remembering God and contemplating His greatness is the key to [patience](#), and patience is a key to Paradise everlasting, therefore this was a wise advice indeed.

7- Be Humble

Try not to act as if you are better than everybody else. [Humility](#) is a much desirable quality for any believer to aspire to. Humility can guide us to Paradise, just as its opposite, arrogance, can lead us into Hell. Satan's arrogance or lack of humility caused not only his expulsion from Paradise but condemned him and his followers to [Hell](#).

Prophet Muhammad did not behave towards others as if he was better than they, nor did he spurn manual work. One of his companions reported that Prophet Muhammad worked happily with servants or workers.

8- Don't Be Arrogant

Walking with insolence through the land is another form of [arrogance](#). It is as if Luqman wanted to emphasize the importance of humility. All people are equal in the eyes of God; the only thing that sets them apart is piety. Prophet Muhammad, his companions and the early generations of Muslims understood the concept of humility.

9- Be Moderate

A native American proverb tells us that "we will be known by the tracks we leave". Luqman is advising his son to walk gently on this earth and not to crash into situations with heavy boots. He is advising that patience and humility should be a person's normal, or as we say these days, default demeanor. Believers should be known for the humility, gentleness and mercy in their behavior.

10- Lower Your Voice

And finally, Luqman advises his son to lower his voice. Being loud and harsh, he says, makes one's voice sound like the braying of donkeys. Shouting does not win hearts, it offends and alienates people.